

giving and sensitisation training, we have also curated several learning and development programmes for our women to build deep functional, technical and leadership skills,” says Lakshmi. For instance, it launched the Vaahini Women in Leadership, a networking space for women MDs.

Accenture’s focus on providing growth and learning opportunities for its employees is one of the key reasons for it being ranked No. 2 on the *BT-Taggd Best Companies to Work For in India* ranking this year. Globally, in FY22, it invested \$1.1 billion and 40 million hours in the training and development of its employees to make them future-ready. It employs nearly 738,000 people globally of which more than 300,000 are in India.

“Our commitment to the growth of our people is evident from the nearly 157,000 promotions at Accenture across the world in FY22,” says Lakshmi. The company has launched iAspire at Accenture’s Advanced Technology Centres in India—a platform that offers visibility to in-demand career paths so that employees can build personalised career journeys and learning paths. “This encourages our people to expand their skill profile to enable sharper matches between skills, aspirations and available opportunities,” says Lakshmi. This has helped employees like Vishwanath Kadkol, Manager, Capability Network, to make a significant career shift by moving into a business consulting role after spending nearly a decade as part of Accenture’s HR function. “I have benefitted immensely from the accelerated learning path that Accenture offered, along with the hands-on exposure of working across industry sectors,” he says.

Accenture is also evolving



KEY HR INITIATIVES

► **Accenture has a six-month-long inclusive internship programme aimed at building a skilled talent pool of transgender candidates**

► **iAspire is a platform that offers visibility to in-demand career paths so that employees can build personalised career journeys**

► **Career Reboot 2.0 programme helps hire and re-skill women professionals who have been on a career break for two years or more**

from being a ‘consumer of talent’ to a ‘creator of talent’. Last year, in addition to hiring engineering graduates, the company hired non-engineering graduates in India and trained them to develop into multi-stack technologists. In India, it also launched the Career Reboot 2.0 programme that helped it hire and reskill experienced women professionals who had been on a career break for two years or more.

Through its ‘Skills to Succeed’ programme, the company has skilled over 1.36 million people in India for participation in the digital economy over the last decade. “In FY22, we piloted a successful initiative to create STEM awareness among schoolgirls in grades 6, 7, and 8, so that we can inspire them to build a career in technology,” says Lakshmi.

Recognition at work is important for most employees. “We heard

that being recognised and recognising others is key to their sense of belonging. Therefore, in FY22, we re-imagined our recognition programme and enabled all our 738,000+ people across the world with monetary award points, so that they can use them to recognise colleagues regularly, and in the moment,” says Lakshmi.

Layoffs have become a harsh reality in today’s world and Accenture hasn’t escaped it either. It recently laid off 19,000 employees globally. However, Lakshmi says the company will continue to hire depending on business demands. “As we continuously pivot to meet new client demands, our focus is to unlock our people’s potential and help them achieve their professional and personal aspirations,” she says. **BT**

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